RTI DATA ANALYSIS REPORT

Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport, Nagpur

Airport Performance & Revenue Analysis — FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25

RTI APPLICATION DETAILS

Reference No.	MIL/111-G/2026/1064
Date of Response	07 April 2026
RTI Filed By	Shri. Chirag Lohakare, New Shukrawari, Mahal, Nagpur-440032 | Contact: 9325215509
Application Date	09 March 2026 (Received by MIL: 12 March 2026)
Responded By	Sr. Airport Director, MIHAN India Limited (MIL) — A Joint Venture of MADC & AAI
Act Invoked	Right to Information Act, 2005
Data Period Covered	FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25 (10 Financial Years)

ABOUT DR. BABASAHEB AMBEDKAR INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT, NAGPUR

Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport (IATA: NAG) is located at Sonegaon, Nagpur, Maharashtra, and is operated by MIHAN India Limited (MIL) — a joint venture between the Maharashtra Airport Development Company (MADC) and the Airports Authority of India (AAI). Situated at India's geographic centre, Nagpur serves as a critical aviation hub connecting Tier-1 metros with Vidarbha, Central India, and Chhattisgarh.

The airport is a strategic node within the MIHAN (Multi-modal International Hub and Special Economic Zone) project — one of India's largest SEZ-cum-airport development initiatives. Over FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25, the airport handled 21+ million passengers, processed 74,000+ MT of cargo, and grew total revenue from ₹4,122 Lakhs to ₹13,953 Lakhs — a 3.4x increase over a decade, positioning it among the fastest-growing airports in the Tier-2 city aviation segment.

28.96 Lakh	10,109 MT	₹13,953 L	25,073
Peak Passengers (FY24-25)	Peak Cargo (FY24-25)	Total Revenue (FY24-25)	Aircraft Movements (FY24-25)

SECTION 1: DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION

1.1 Passenger Traffic Analysis (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25)

Sr.	Financial Year	Domestic PAX	International PAX	Total PAX
1	**2015-16**	14,83,014	70,010	**15,53,024**
2	**2016-17**	17,91,607	1,09,403	**19,01,010**
3	**2017-18**	20,70,543	1,05,896	**21,76,439**
4	**2018-19**	27,00,756	1,03,823	**28,04,579**
5	**2019-20**	29,33,907	1,19,477	**30,53,384**
6	**2020-21**	9,53,705	248	**9,53,953**
7	**2021-22**	15,93,122	11,227	**16,04,349**
8	**2022-23**	24,97,862	64,824	**25,62,686**
9	**2023-24**	26,92,537	1,04,475	**27,97,012**
10	**2024-25**	27,96,310	99,637	**28,95,947**

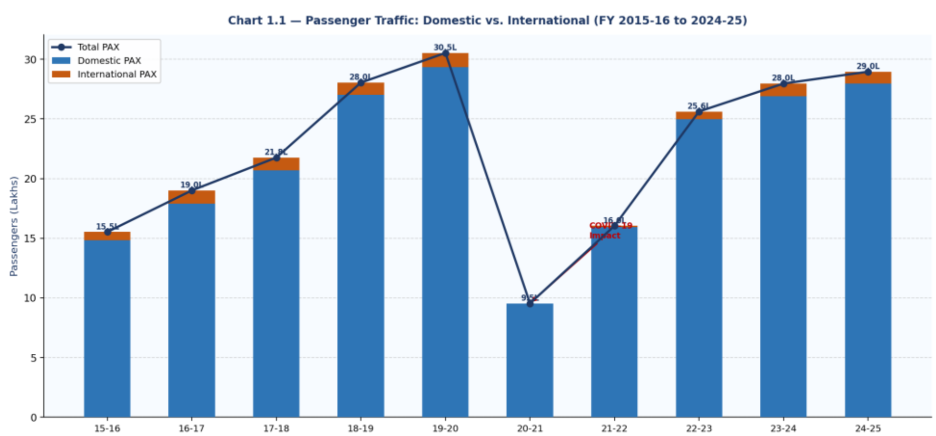


Chart 1.1 — Passenger Traffic Trend: Domestic vs. International (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25)

Key Observations — Passenger Traffic

- Pre-COVID peak: FY 2019-20 recorded 30.53 lakh total passengers — the highest pre-pandemic level, reflecting rapid aviation demand growth in Central India.
- COVID impact (FY 2020-21): Total traffic collapsed to just 9.54 lakh — a 68.7% year-on-year decline. International traffic fell to near-zero (only 248 passengers) due to global travel restrictions.
- Strong recovery: By FY 2022-23, the airport returned to near pre-COVID levels, and FY 2024-25 achieved its all-time peak at 28.96 lakh passengers.

- International underperformance: International PAX (99,637 in FY 2024-25) is still 16.6% below the FY 2019-20 level (1,19,477), indicating continued weakness in international connectivity.
- Domestic dominance: Domestic passengers consistently account for 96–99% of total traffic, reflecting the airport's domestic-oriented character.

1.2 Cargo Traffic Analysis (FY 2017-18 to FY 2024-25)

Financial Year	Total IN (MT)	Total OUT (MT)	Total Cargo (MT)
2017-18	4,339.44	3,149.15	**7,488.59**
2018-19	4,650.69	3,145.53	**7,796.22**
2019-20	4,537.59	3,221.60	**7,759.19**
2020-21	4,830.21	2,058.44	**6,888.65**
2021-22	5,544.59	2,676.08	**8,220.67**
2022-23	6,054.88	3,290.32	**9,345.20**
2023-24	5,176.64	3,636.60	**8,813.24**
2024-25	6,162.89	3,946.45	**10,109.34**

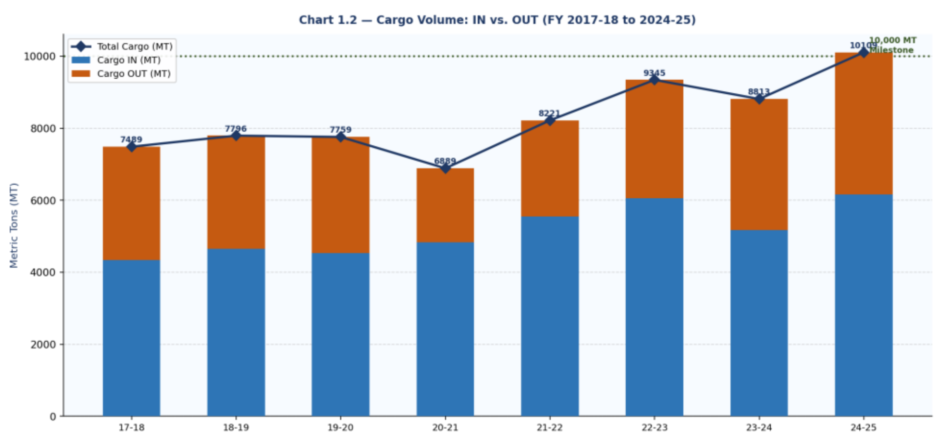


Chart 1.2 — Cargo Volume Trend: IN vs. OUT (FY 2017-18 to FY 2024-25)

Key Observations — Cargo

- Consistent growth: Total cargo grew from 7,488 MT (FY 2017-18) to 10,109 MT (FY 2024-25) — a 35% increase over 7 years, breaching the 10,000 MT milestone for the first time.
- IN cargo dominance: Inbound cargo consistently outpaces outbound at a ~60:40 ratio, suggesting Nagpur is primarily an import/consumption hub rather than an export hub.
- Outbound surge: Outbound cargo rose from 2,058 MT (FY 2020-21) to 3,946 MT (FY 2024-25) — a 91.7% jump in 4 years — likely driven by e-commerce, pharma, and Vidarbha agri-produce exports.

- FY 2024-25 milestone: For the first time, the airport crossed 10,000 MT in total cargo, a significant operational milestone that signals readiness for dedicated cargo infrastructure.

1.3 Aircraft Movements (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25)

Financial Year	Total Movements (ARR + DEP)	YoY Change
2015-16	16,781	—
2016-17	17,620	**+5.0%**
2017-18	19,041	**+8.1%**
2018-19	25,528	**+34.1%**
2019-20	22,751	**-10.9%**
2020-21	10,206	**-55.2%**
2021-22	15,063	**+47.6%**
2022-23	24,905	**+65.3%**
2023-24	25,403	**+2.0%**
2024-25	25,073	**-1.3%**

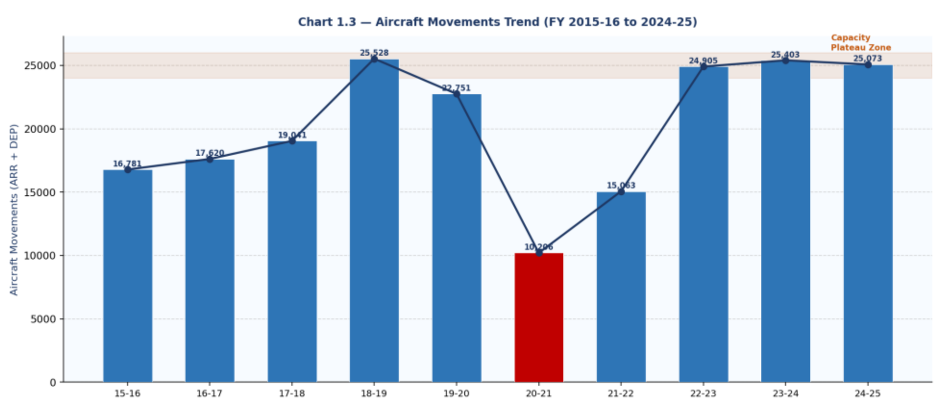


Chart 1.3 — Aircraft Movements Trend (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25)

Key Observations — Aircraft Movements

- Pre-COVID peak: FY 2018-19 recorded 25,528 movements — the highest pre-pandemic level, driven by rapid airline capacity expansion.
- COVID collapse and recovery: Movements fell to 10,206 in FY 2020-21 (a 60% drop) but recovered sharply to 24,905 by FY 2022-23.
- Operational plateau: Movements have hovered around 25,000 since FY 2018-19, suggesting possible runway or slot capacity constraints limiting further growth.

- Load factor improvement: Passengers per movement rose from ~34 (FY 2015-16) to ~58 (FY 2024-25) — airlines are deploying larger, fuller aircraft, a strong efficiency signal.

1.4 Airport Revenue Analysis (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25) [₹ in Lakhs]

Financial Year	Aeronautical Rev. (₹ L)	Non-Aeronautical Rev. (₹ L)	Total Revenue (₹ L)
FY 2015-16	2,752.73	1,369.73	**4,122.47**
FY 2016-17	3,260.46	1,637.18	**4,897.64**
FY 2017-18	4,998.88	2,255.96	**7,254.84**
FY 2018-19	9,953.34	2,612.79	**12,566.13**
FY 2019-20	9,159.82	2,530.24	**11,690.06**
FY 2020-21	3,150.45	854.77	**4,005.22**
FY 2021-22	5,077.99	994.80	**6,072.79**
FY 2022-23	7,556.95	1,795.34	**9,352.29**
FY 2023-24	8,179.42	1,923.68	**10,103.10**
FY 2024-25	11,560.38	2,392.68	**13,953.06**

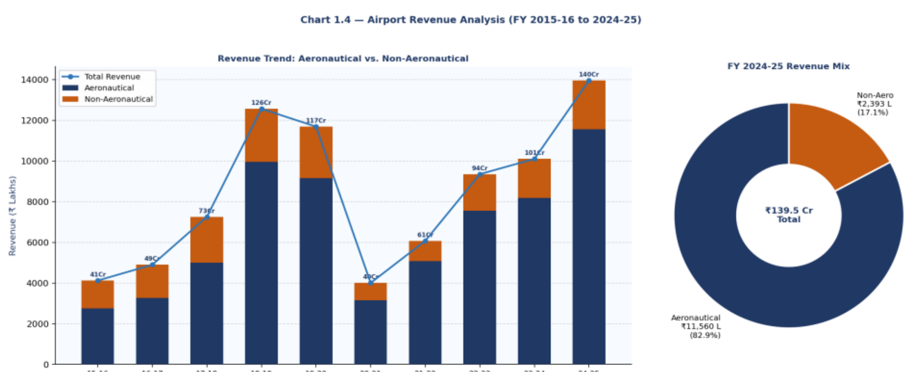


Chart 1.4 — Revenue Breakdown: Aeronautical vs. Non-Aeronautical (₹ Lakhs) | FY Mix: Donut Chart (Right)

Key Observations — Revenue

- Revenue tripling: Total revenue grew from ₹4,122 Lakhs (FY 2015-16) to ₹13,953 Lakhs (FY 2024-25) — a CAGR of approximately 12.9% over the decade.
- Non-aeronautical revenue (NAR) severely underperforms: NAR peaked at ₹2,613 Lakhs in FY 2018-19 but stood at only ₹2,393 Lakhs in FY 2024-25 — still below pre-COVID levels despite higher passenger volumes. NAR as a % of total revenue declined from ~33% in FY 2015-16 to ~17% in FY 2024-25.
- Aeronautical dependency: The airport is heavily reliant on aeronautical sources (landing fees, UDF) — which carry regulatory caps — limiting upside pricing power.

- FY 2024-25 record revenue: At ₹13,953 Lakhs, this is the airport's highest-ever annual revenue, with a 41.3% jump in aeronautical revenue over FY 2023-24.

1.5 Capital Expenditure Analysis (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25) [₹ in Lakhs]

Financial Year	Capital Expenditure (₹ Lakhs)
FY 2015-16	174.19
FY 2016-17	1,344.84
FY 2017-18	1,296.53
FY 2018-19	1,541.40
FY 2019-20	569.09
FY 2020-21	698.71
FY 2021-22	2,341.82
FY 2022-23	865.23
FY 2023-24	1,074.42
FY 2024-25	**4,084.69**

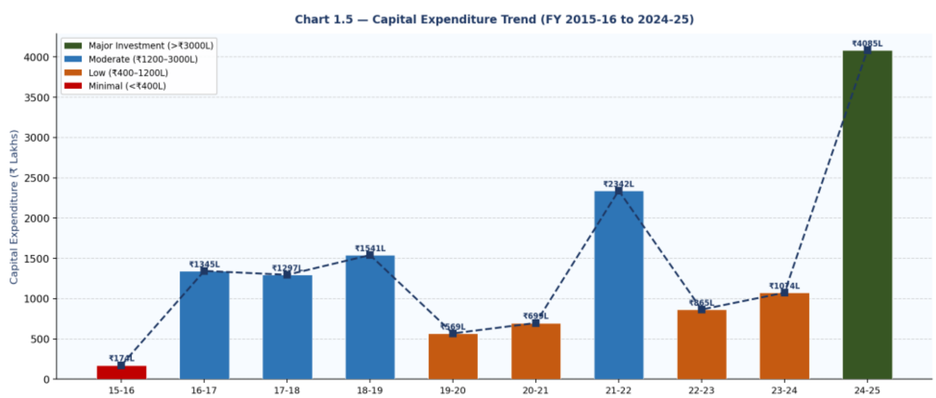


Chart 1.5 — Capital Expenditure Trend (FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25)

Key Observations — Capital Expenditure

- FY 2024-25 CapEx surge: At ₹4,084 Lakhs, CapEx is the highest in the dataset — nearly 4x the FY 2023-24 level, signaling major infrastructure investments likely linked to MIHAN expansion or cargo terminal upgrades.
- Post-COVID investment wave: After muted spending during FY 2019-21, a new investment cycle began in FY 2021-22, indicating management confidence in long-term growth.
- CapEx-Revenue correlation: Higher CapEx years tend to precede or coincide with peak revenue years — returns on infrastructure investment appear to materialise within 1–2 years.

SECTION 2: FINDINGS OF THE RTI DATA

Based on a decade of operational data obtained through the RTI filing, the following key findings are drawn:

FINDING 1 — Strong Long-Term Growth Trajectory

The airport demonstrated robust long-term growth across all key metrics: passengers (+86%), cargo (+35%), aircraft movements (+49%), and total revenue (+239%) from FY 2015-16 to FY 2024-25. The CAGR of total revenue at ~12.9% is significantly above India's average airport revenue CAGR, confirming Nagpur as one of the fastest-growing Tier-2 airport markets in the country.

FINDING 2 — COVID-19 Had Severe but Temporary Impact

FY 2020-21 saw catastrophic declines: passengers fell 68.7%, aircraft movements fell 60%, and total revenue fell 65.7%. However, the airport demonstrated strong resilience — recovering to pre-COVID passenger levels by FY 2022-23 and achieving all-time records in FY 2024-25 across all four key operational metrics.

FINDING 3 — Critical Weakness: Non-Aeronautical Revenue Is Severely Underutilized

Non-aeronautical revenue (NAR) — retail, F&B, advertising, parking, lounges, cargo fees, and real estate — declined as a percentage of total revenue from ~33% (FY 2015-16) to ~17% (FY 2024-25). Absolute NAR in FY 2024-25 (₹2,393 Lakhs) remains below FY 2018-19 levels (₹2,613 Lakhs), despite significantly higher passenger volumes. This is the single largest untapped revenue optimization opportunity.

FINDING 4 — International Traffic Recovery Remains Incomplete

International passengers (99,637 in FY 2024-25) are still 16.6% below the FY 2019-20 pre-COVID peak of 1,19,477. The airport lacks direct international routes to Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and East Africa — regions with strong Vidarbha diaspora and trade linkages. Each additional international flight yields 2–4x higher revenue per movement versus comparable domestic flights.

FINDING 5 — Aircraft Movements Plateau Suggests Capacity Constraints

Aircraft movements have hovered between 24,905 and 25,528 since FY 2018-19 despite growing passenger numbers. The passenger-per-movement ratio rising from ~34 to ~58 over the decade indicates airlines are deploying larger aircraft to work within capacity constraints.

Without infrastructure expansion, this plateau will cap both passenger growth and aeronautical revenue growth.

FINDING 6 — Cargo Outbound Segment Shows Exponential Export Potential

Outbound cargo grew 91.7% from FY 2020-21 to FY 2024-25, significantly outpacing inbound growth. This signals emergence of Vidarbha's export capacity — driven by pharmaceutical manufacturing, orange and soybean agri-produce, and e-commerce logistics. The timely FY 2024-25 CapEx surge of ₹4,084 Lakhs is well-positioned to capture this growth if directed toward dedicated cargo infrastructure.

FINDING 7 — Lean Employee Base (104 Staff) May Constrain Commercial Scale-Up

MIHAN India Limited operates with only 104 employees as of the RTI filing date. For an airport handling ~29 lakh annual passengers and managing complex multi-modal infrastructure, this headcount raises questions about operational scalability and the capacity to develop and execute new commercial initiatives — particularly in the non-aeronautical revenue and cargo domains where active business development is required.

SECTION 3: RECOMMENDATIONS TO IMPROVE AIRPORT REVENUE

The following three recommendations are data-driven, practical, and directly address the revenue gaps identified in the findings. Each is supported by an implementation framework, expected financial impact, and a visual diagram.

RECOMMENDATION 1: BUILD A NON-AERONAUTICAL REVENUE (NAR) EXPANSION PROGRAM

Rationale:

Non-aeronautical revenue at Nagpur airport (₹2,393 Lakhs in FY 2024-25) represents only 17% of total revenue — far below the global benchmark of 35–45% for comparable airports. With 28.96 lakh passengers, even a modest improvement in spend-per-passenger from ~₹83 to ₹200 (still well below Delhi/Mumbai's ₹400+) would generate an additional ₹34 crore per year.

Implementation Framework:

1. Retail & F&B Tender Optimization: Renegotiate retail and food & beverage concession agreements to include revenue-share models with minimum guarantees, replacing flat-fee structures. Target best-in-class regional brands from Nagpur — Haldiram's, Saoji cuisine, local confectionery, and national QSR chains.
2. Premium Lounge Monetization: Develop a paid-access executive lounge (targeting corporate travelers from MIHAN SEZ companies) with partner bank lounge tie-ups and MICE facilities, generating ₹1,000–2,000 revenue per visit.
3. Advertising & Branding Revenue: Install high-visibility digital display networks (LED boards, pillar wraps, jetway branding) and offer 6-month/annual contracts to FMCG, real estate, and auto companies targeting the Vidarbha market. Target: ₹5–8 crore/year from advertising alone.
4. Airport Real Estate & Cargo Land Leasing: Leverage MIHAN's land bank to develop bonded warehousing, cold storage, and pharma logistics parks — leasing under long-term agreements for recurring rental income independent of traffic cycles.
5. Parking Revenue Enhancement: Implement dynamic pricing for multi-level parking, introduce monthly subscription passes for SEZ employees, and develop a valet service for the premium segment.

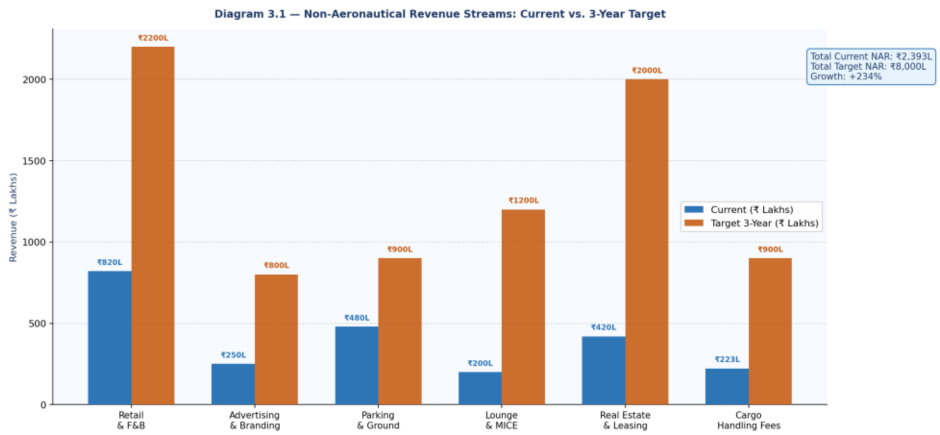


Diagram 3.1 — Non-Aeronautical Revenue Streams: Current Estimated Split vs. 3-Year Target (₹ Lakhs)

Expected Impact:

If NAR is increased from 17% to 30% of total revenue at current revenue levels, it would generate an additional ₹34–42 crore annually. This is achievable within 3 years without requiring any additional flights or passenger growth.

RECOMMENDATION 2: DEVELOP A DEDICATED CARGO & LOGISTICS REVENUE HUB

Rationale:

Cargo crossed 10,000 MT in FY 2024-25 — a significant milestone. Outbound cargo nearly doubled in 4 years. Nagpur's unique geographic advantage as India's geographic centroid, combined with MIHAN SEZ's logistics and manufacturing presence, creates ideal conditions for it to become India's premier inland air cargo hub. The FY 2024-25 CapEx surge (₹4,084 Lakhs) aligns perfectly with this strategic opportunity.

Implementation Framework:

6. Air Cargo Terminal Expansion: Use the FY 2024-25 CapEx investment to build a modern multi-user cargo terminal with RFID tracking, refrigerated storage for pharma and fresh produce, and bonded warehousing capacity of 50,000+ MT/year.
7. Dedicated Freighter Flights: Work with cargo airlines (Blue Dart, IndiGo Cargo, SpiceXpress, Quikjet) to establish dedicated freighter routes to Delhi, Mumbai, Hyderabad, Chennai, and Kolkata — replacing reliance on belly-hold capacity and enabling time-sensitive, high-value cargo movement.
8. Cold Chain & Pharma Logistics Park: Partner with Nagpur's pharmaceutical cluster and Vidarbha's orange/agri-produce exporters to develop temperature-controlled logistics facilities, positioning Nagpur as the air cargo gateway for the Central Indian pharma and agri belt.
9. E-Commerce Fulfillment Centre: Tie up with Amazon, Flipkart, and Meesho logistics arms to set up a regional fulfillment hub within MIHAN SEZ, generating high-frequency cargo movements and stable handling fee income.

10. Cargo Revenue Diversification: Introduce differential pricing — premium rates for pharma, perishables, and hazmat; standard rates for general cargo — to maximize revenue per kilogram rather than just volume.

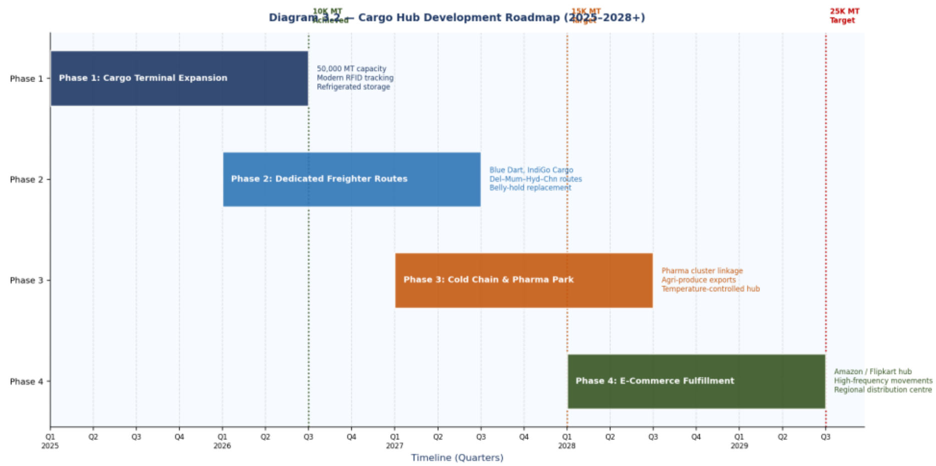


Diagram 3.2 — Cargo Hub Development Roadmap: Phase-wise Timeline & Milestones (2025–2028)

Expected Impact:

A cargo hub strategy could grow cargo volume to 25,000+ MT by FY 2029-30, generating ₹20–30 crore in additional cargo handling fees and ancillary revenue annually — while also attracting new freight-related industries to the MIHAN SEZ, amplifying overall airport footfall and aeronautical income.

RECOMMENDATION 3: LAUNCH AN INTERNATIONAL ROUTE DEVELOPMENT FUND (RDF) PROGRAM

Rationale:

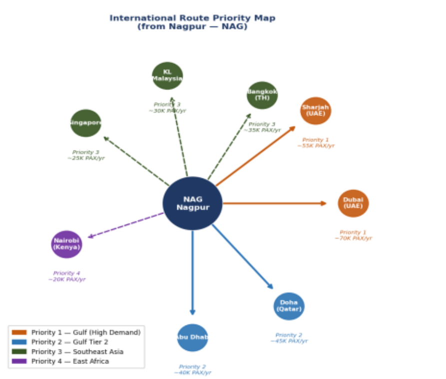
International passenger traffic (99,637 in FY 2024-25) remains 16.6% below pre-COVID levels and delivers disproportionately high revenue per passenger through airport charges, forex, duty-free, and premium retail. A single new international route (e.g., Nagpur–Dubai) can add 50,000–80,000 passengers annually, generating ₹2–5 crore in direct additional revenue while multiplying non-aeronautical income. Nagpur's strong diaspora to the Middle East, Southeast Asia, and East Africa currently routes via connecting hubs in Delhi or Mumbai.

Implementation Framework:

11. Route Development Fund (RDF): Create a joint MIHAN-Maharashtra government RDF offering airlines marketing support, reduced landing fees, and ground handling rebates for the first 2 years on new direct international routes — a proven global model used by airports in Kochi, Ahmedabad, and Bhopal.
12. Priority Route Targets: Focus on high-demand origin-destination pairs: Nagpur–Dubai/Sharjah (NRI diaspora, pilgrimage, trade), Nagpur–Bangkok/Kuala Lumpur (tourism and trade), Nagpur–Doha/Abu Dhabi (Gulf labour market + premium leisure).

13. MICE & Business Tourism Infrastructure: Develop a convention centre and transit hotel within the airport premises to attract international business conferences linked to MIHAN SEZ’s manufacturing and IT tenants — creating guaranteed demand for new international routes.
14. Duty-Free & Forex Monetization: Pre-negotiate international-standard duty-free retail and forex exchange concessions contingent on successful international route launch — ensuring NAR benefits are locked in before routes commence.
15. Diaspora Engagement Program: Partner with Nagpur-origin NRI associations in Gulf countries, UK, and USA to promote direct flights, run awareness campaigns, and lobby airlines for route launches — a low-cost, high-impact demand generation strategy.

Diagram 3.3 — International Route Development: Priority Map & RDF Incentive Framework



Route Development Fund (RDF) Incentive Structure

Route Tier	Landing Fee Discount	Ground Rebate	Mktg Support	Min. Freq Required
Priority 1	50% (Yr1) 30% (Yr2)	40%	₹50L/route	4x/week
Priority 2	40% (Yr1) 20% (Yr2)	30%	₹30L/route	3x/week
Priority 3	30% (Yr1) 15% (Yr2)	20%	₹20L/route	3x/week
Priority 4	20% (Yr1) 10% (Yr2)	15%	₹15L/route	2x/week

Diagram 3.3 — International Route Priority Map & Route Development Fund (RDF) Incentive Framework

Expected Impact:

Adding 3–5 new international routes over a 3-year window could increase international PAX from ~1 lakh to 4–5 lakh annually, generating ₹15–25 crore in combined aeronautical and non-aeronautical revenue growth. The RDF investment (₹2–3 crore/year) would deliver a 7–10x revenue return within 2–3 years of route maturity.

SECTION 4: STRATEGIC SUMMARY

Recommendation	Core Action	Timeline	Revenue Potential
1. NAR Expansion Program	Retail, F&B, Lounge, Advertising, Parking, Real Estate monetization	12–36 months	**+₹34–42 Cr/year**
2. Cargo & Logistics Hub	Freighter routes, cold chain park, e-commerce fulfillment, cargo pricing	24–48 months	**+₹20–30 Cr/year**
3. International Route Development Fund	RDF incentives, priority routes, MICE infrastructure, diaspora engagement	18–36 months	**+₹15–25 Cr/year**
COMBINED IMPACT	Diversified revenue, reduced aeronautical dependency, restored international connectivity	3–5 Years	**+₹69–97 Cr/year**

Disclaimer:

This report is an independent analytical exercise prepared using data obtained through the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005. Revenue projections are indicative estimates based on industry benchmarks and historical trends. This report does not represent the official view of MIHAN India Limited, AAI, MADC, or the Government of Maharashtra.